

Joint Analysis

Current knowledge regarding generative AI

Throughout the interviews, it became clear that most participants had limited knowledge of generative AI. While they were familiar with the concept, their understanding was often shallow, mostly confined to surface-level information. A few participants mentioned hearing about tools like ChatGPT or seeing AI in media, but they had not explored the technology deeply or used it in a meaningful way.

In many cases, their awareness was primarily shaped by the media or casual exposure, and they lacked a comprehensive understanding of how generative AI could be applied in their workplace or industry. This gap in knowledge was consistent across participants, and it contributed to a sense of uncertainty about what AI can truly do. For example, one participant admitted they had only used AI "a couple of times," but did not fully grasp its capabilities beyond generating basic text.

Concerns

1. Lack of human interaction

Most of the participants expressed fears and concerns regarding the lack of a human element in AI. At one point, one of the participants used ChatGPT to generate some text for his work that was directed to their customers, and his boss called him out on using such tools in that specific context, telling him that is not the way they talk to their customers. Thinking about the fact that there is no human behind the responses that the Generative AI they use bothers them. They were also doubtful of AI being able to perform human tasks that require human judgment and empathy, which goes back to the point that the missing human element to AI is a problem for them.

2. Data Privacy Concerns

Some of them had concerns regarding their own data and information. Specifically, with ChatGPT and other forms of generative AI. Whenever they used ChatGPT, they wondered where it was being stored and for what it was being used. One of them stated, "If I put things in AI, like ChatGPT, where is it? Who has it?" Tying into that, they were also concerned about people using AI tools to do harm, specifically with other people's information and likeness. For example, using someone else's face and voice

to create false AI videos, portraying them in an undesirable way. So they are in fear that perhaps their own data might get used against them using AI.

3. AI overperformance

This can also be linked with the data privacy concerns from earlier, most of them feared what AI can do. They all realize the incredible things AI can do, whether that be for good or bad. But there will always be bad actors in our world, and they will take advantage of the power of AI and use it for malicious purposes. In one case, the participant was quite fearful of what AI could do, so much so that he rejects AI and would rather not get involved in the new technology, but at the end of it he was still open to learning more about it, as long as it benefitted him and his business in a positive manner.

4. AI portrayal pop culture and media

All participants acknowledged that the general media has an influence on how they see AI, meaning that it could lead to them having misconceptions about AI that was given to them by way of the media or pop-culture material. They realize that it's a dangerous fact of the world, information is too easily believed, and the negatives of AI that are exasperated by the media are too focused on giving birth to more negative views on AI, causing a spiral of negativity and rejection of AI.

5. Job replacement

All interviewers expressed little to no concern about AI replacing their own jobs and positions, as of right now. But they all realize that AI is currently replacing many jobs and will continue to do so in the future as many companies take advantage of the chance at automating tasks and job roles with the use of AI, wherever possible. So, to them, in their positions AI does not pose any immediate dangers.

6. AI as main source of information

In one of the cases, the participant expressed concerns that AI would become the main source of information for people. Upon having bad experiences using GenAI, giving him incorrect information or just not listening to his prompts, he concluded that it has still not reached its last point and has many improvements to go through. So, the fact that people would start using that as their daily source of information is worrying to him.

Willingness to learn

1. Eagerness to Learn & Time Allocation

Across all the interviews, participants expressed a moderate willingness to learn about AI. Most were open to dedicating time to upskilling, with each interviewee willing to allocate at least 2 hours a week toward learning. One participant was even ready to invest between 4 to 6 hours per week, showing an elevated level of eagerness. This eagerness seems to stem from a recognition that AI will become increasingly relevant in their job roles, and staying updated could benefit their careers and even personal lives.

2. Barriers to Learning

Despite the willingness, several barriers were noted. Time management issues were a common theme. Interviewees mentioned that their heavy personal lives and work schedules made it difficult to find time for learning innovative technologies like AI. This balancing act between work and personal life left them with little energy or motivation to engage in additional training.

Another prominent barrier was the overall disinterest in AI within their companies. Some participants felt isolated in their desire to learn, as there was a general lack of interest or push from management. This disinterest created a discouraging environment, as employees didn't see AI learning as a priority within their workplace.

Additionally, the overwhelming nature of AI as a subject was brought up. One interviewee admitted that they did not know where to start and felt they lacked a foundational knowledge base. Without this, the interviewee felt that learning about AI seemed like an uphill battle, which further decreased their motivation.

3. Learning Methods

When asked about their preferred learning methods, participants showed a strong inclination toward flexible, self-paced options. Online courses and video materials were frequently mentioned as ideal ways to learn, as they offered the freedom to explore the subject at their own pace. There was a noticeable preference for non-traditional learning environments, where participants could choose when and how they engaged with the material.

Other learning methods included literature on AI and hands-on experience with AI tools. However, these methods were mentioned less often. One participant expressed a desire for practical, process-based learning, where they could engage with AI tools in real-world scenarios to better understand their applications.

4. Uncertainty Drives Curiosity

Interestingly, uncertainty about AI's real capabilities often sparked curiosity. Several participants were motivated to learn more because they did not fully understand AI or its impact. This curiosity acted as a positive driver, making them

more open to learning. They saw the gaps in their knowledge as opportunities to explore, rather than reasons to avoid AI altogether.

5. Willingness Despite Barriers

While participants acknowledged the barriers to learning, many felt that if the willingness were there, they would still be available for it. Even with time constraints, disinterest from colleagues, or lack of management support, the overall feeling was that their curiosity and recognition of AI's growing importance would eventually drive them to engage in learning, given the right opportunities and resources.